Daniel Okafor-Reyes

Backend Engineer | Java, Kotlin, Spring Boot, Kafka

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Backend engineer with professional experience building and operating Java and Kotlin services since 2019. Experienced in designing REST APIs, working with PostgreSQL, Kafka, Kubernetes and AWS, and improving service reliability through automated testing and event-processing patterns. On-call experience includes investigating production incidents. Python experience to date is limited to scripts; currently learning Go through a personal CLI project.

CORE SKILLS

Backend and APIs: Java, Kotlin, Spring Boot, REST APIs, OpenAPI 3, rate limiting
Databases and messaging: PostgreSQL, Oracle, Redis, Kafka, RabbitMQ, transactional outbox, idempotent consumers
Testing and delivery: Testcontainers, contract testing, Docker
Cloud and operations: Kubernetes (EKS), AWS S3 and SQS (service user), on-call incident response
Additional languages: Python (scripts for data fixes and small Jenkins helpers); Go (personal learning project, not production)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Backend Engineer | Tejo Insurance Tech | 2022-Present

- Build and maintain Java and Kotlin Spring Boot microservices using Kafka, PostgreSQL, Kubernetes and AWS services.
- Designed a versioned OpenAPI 3 REST API for insurance brokers; 12 partners were onboarded, with around 400,000 quote requests per month.
- Fixed duplicate claim records caused by at-least-once Kafka delivery by implementing a transactional outbox and idempotency keys; duplicate claims fell from around 40 per week to zero over the following quarter.
- Built a small internal Kotlin and Spring Boot service to render policy PDFs from templates and wrote the team's Kotlin coding guidelines.
- Take part in the on-call rota one week per month; handled a major Kafka lag incident in March 2024, and the incident write-up was praised.
- Run the backend guild meeting every two weeks, a responsibility held since 2024.

Software Developer | Viajar Online | 2019-2021

- Worked on the booking and payments parts of a large Java application.
- Increased test coverage of the payments module from 35% to 70% using Testcontainers, enabling safer refactoring.
- Extracted email and SMS notifications from the booking monolith into a separate Spring Boot service using RabbitMQ and Thymeleaf.

PERSONAL PROJECT

OpenAPI Specification Diff CLI | Go

- Developing a Go CLI to diff OpenAPI specifications as a learning project; approximately 600 lines of code and available on GitHub. Not a production service.

CERTIFICATION

Oracle Certified Professional Java SE 11 Developer | 2020

LANGUAGE

English: used as the working language at Tejo Insurance Tech.